

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL - RFP 2026029331 – EXHIBIT A

SECTION 2: PROJECT OVERVIEW & TECHNICAL ACCEPTABILITY REQUIREMENTS

1. Background and history:

- a. Noxious weed and vegetation control is essential to protecting NLR's people, facilities, and mission. Unmanaged weeds and vegetation create safety hazards, increase wildfire risk, damage infrastructure, and can interfere with access to buildings, utilities, fire breaks, and research areas across NLR's three campuses. Left unaddressed, invasive and noxious species can spread rapidly, leading to higher long-term maintenance costs and potential regulatory violations.
- b. The work is also necessary to ensure NLR remains compliant with federal, state, and local environmental, pesticide, and land-management regulations. Herbicide application on an active federal research campus must be performed by properly licensed professionals using approved products and controlled methods to protect staff, visitors, sensitive research activities, wetlands, and surrounding ecosystems.
- c. By subcontracting these services, NLR is safeguarding its facilities and grounds, reducing environmental and operational risk, and maintaining a safe, functional, and professional campus environment that supports uninterrupted research, collaboration, and innovation.

2. Subcontract need summary:

- a. NLR is looking for a qualified subcontractor who has specialized expertise, licensing, and equipment. This work requires specialized application equipment, chemical handling procedures, reporting and environmental controls tailored to varying site conditions (wetlands, etc.). By utilizing a qualified subcontractor, NLR ensures the work is performed safely, legally and effectively.

1. Timeline:

The period of performance for this Subcontract shall be as follows:

Basic Period: Execution through Twelve (12) Months

Option Period 1: Completion of Basic Period through Twelve (12) Months

Option Period 2: Completion of Option Period 1 through Twelve (12) Months

Option Period 3: Completion of Option Period 2 through Twelve (12) Months

Option Period 4: Completion of Option Period 3 through Twelve (12) Months

2. Basic Mandatory Qualifications

To be considered a 'responsive offeror' the following minimum criteria must be met. These criteria are not evaluated but are instead 'pass/fail' criteria. NLR reserves the right to ask clarifying questions of the offerors as necessary in determining responsiveness to this RFP. Offerors' proposals that do not meet the mandatory qualifications will not be evaluated or considered further for award under this solicitation.

- a. Safety Program must be provided by the Offeror.
- b. Complete the Environmental, Safety and Health Subcontract Risk Evaluation Worksheet attached to this solicitation. For response to the solicitation, these worksheets are required of the offeror. Following award, these will be required for all proposed lower-tier Subcontractors.
- c. If the offeror has been issued any violations by the EPA or CDPHE within the past three years, copies of all violations are required with the proposal. If the offeror has not been issued any violations by the EPA or CDPHE within the past three years, please indicate as such on the technical proposal cover letter.
- d. Offeror must demonstrate a record of positive or, at a minimum, neutral past performance on projects of comparable scope per the details of the Statement of Work, size, and complexity. Past performance will be evaluated based on factors such as quality of work, timeliness, cost control, and overall customer satisfaction. History of unsatisfactory or negative performance may be grounds for disqualification from meeting the mandatory qualification requirements.
- e. All work shall be performed directly by the Offeror's own personnel and may not be subcontracted, assigned, or otherwise delegated to any lower-tier subcontractors or third parties without prior written authorization. The Offeror is expected to maintain full responsibility, control, and accountability for the execution, quality, and compliance of all services performed.
- f. The Offeror must have established and readily available resources aligned with the scope of work prior to contract award to ensure successful performance of all requirements outlined in the Statement of Work. These resources shall include, at a minimum, qualified personnel, appropriate equipment, technical expertise, and operational capacity necessary to execute the work efficiently and in compliance with all contractual standards. The Offeror shall demonstrate that such resources are in

place and can be mobilized immediately upon award, with no reliance on future acquisition or uncertain arrangements that could impact performance.

- g. Offeror must be located within 50 miles of NLR South Table Mountain Campus.
- h. All Subcontractor employees working on-site as Certified Herbicide Applicators shall be Colorado certified with instruction in the following categories: Category 107: Rangeland Pest Control, Category 108: Aquatic Pest Control, Category 109: Industrial and Right-of-Way Weed Control, Category 206: Turf Pest Control, Category 207: Ornamental Pest Control, Category 304: Residential/Commercial Pest Control. Copies of certifications must be provided.
- i. Offeror must demonstrate the ability to identify weed species and recommend appropriate pre-emergent and post-emergent pesticides, whether listed in item (h), above, or not.
- j. Offeror must provide all required tools, equipment, vehicles and application devices necessary to perform the work.
- k. Offeror must utilize herbicide application equipment that meets the Statement of Work specifications.

#	Technical Acceptability Requirement
5.1	Past Performance - The Offeror's organizational history and relevant project experience.
5.1.1.	Organizational History: Provide a summary of how long your firm has been in business and the types of work completed.
5.1.2.	Past Performance Projects – Noxious Weed and Vegetation Control:

#	Technical Acceptability Requirement
	Provide summaries of at least two noxious weed and vegetation control projects completed within the last three years similar in scope to those outlined in the Statement of Work. Each summary shall include the following: Company Type (commercial, industrial, government), Scope of the project, Materials Cost associated with the project, Labor cost associated with the project, Response time from Initial Request, Period of Performance Required to complete the project (Start and End date of Work).
5.2.	On-Site Staff Experience - The qualifications and availability of the firm's proposed project team and on-site staffing.
5.2.1	SOW SECTION (4)(C): Personnel Requirements Demonstrate your firm currently has two members of staff who can act as Key Personnel on the subcontract requirement by providing Key Personnel Names, Phone Numbers, and Email Addresses.
5.2.2	SOW SECTION (4)(C): Personnel Requirements Demonstrate your firm currently has at least two members of staff that currently hold the following certifications/qualifications per section (4)(C)(2)(i) of the SOW: • Category 107: Rangeland Pest Control • Category 108: Aquatic Pest Control • Category 109: Industrial and Right-of-Way Weed Control • Category 206: Turf Pest Control • Category 207: Ornamental Pest Control • Category 304: Residential/Commercial Pest Control Copies of all required certifications must be provided to be considered technically acceptable. Experience shall be provided in the form of a resume.
5.3.	Capability - The Offeror's demonstrated ability to perform the requirements outlined in the Statement of Work (SoW).
5.3.1.	SOW SECTION (5) – Scheduled Tasks Demonstrate your firm can meet or exceed the current response times required by the Statement of Work. Provide your average response time to phone call requests, including: 1. Normal Business Hours 2. After-Hours (Emergency, Non-Holiday)

#	Technical Acceptability Requirement
	3. Emergency (Holiday) Statement of Work requires the following response times: All seasons, locations, and projects are “Within 5-10 business days of NLR Technical Monitor or Subject Matter Expert request.”
5.3.2.	Location: Confirm location of facilities, key personnel/staff, and equipment are within 50-mile drive of NLR’s main site in Golden, CO.
5.3.3.	Confirm your ability to comply with the Service Contract Labor Standards Wage Determination 2015-5419 and/or provide a copy of your organization's Collective Bargaining Agreement for review.
5.4.	Required Forms - Provide all required Forms as outlined in the Request for Proposal.
5.4.1.	Offeror shall provide all required forms outlined in the RFP. 1. Provide Completed ESH Worksheet (NLR F1320-E (12/2017). 2. Provide Insurance Carrier Letter (EMRs). 3. Provide copies (if any) of Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) and Colorado Department of Public Health & Environment (CDPHE) violations within the past three (3) years. 4. Provide Completed Organization Conflicts of Interest Disclosure Statement OR Organizational Conflicts of Interest Representation Statement Form. 5. Provide Completed Representations and Certifications Form. 6. Provide Completed Price Proposal Form.

Basic Qualification Matrix	Supplemental Proposal Submission Requirement
Colorado Commercial Pesticide Applicator License: • Qualified Supervisor • Certified Operator	Provide a Copy of license
Registered with the Colorado Department of Agriculture	Provide a copy of license
Demonstrates capability to perform noxious weed and vegetation control across a large multi-campus site	Provide previous work history showcasing similar work experience